SEBASTIAN FISHER COACHING

STRENGTH & SIZE

20-WEEK POWERBUILDING PROGRAMME

HEAVY COMPOUNDS · HYPERTROPHY ACCESSORIES · ADVANCED

PROGRAMME OVERVIEW

A 20-week powerbuilding programme for advanced lifters who want to get stronger AND bigger. Five training days per week. Each session opens with a heavy compound movement trained for strength (low reps, high intensity), followed by hypertrophy-focused accessory work. Built in 4-week blocks with progressive intensity.

Training split: Push / Pull / Legs / Upper / Lower (5 days/week)
Session length: 70-85 minutes
Experience required: 2+ years consistent training, familiar with RPE
Equipment needed: Full gym — barbell, dumbbells, cables, machines, dip/pull-up bars

WHO THIS IS FOR

This programme is NOT for beginners. You should have a solid base of strength (rough minimums: 1.25x BW bench, 1.5x BW squat, 2x BW deadlift) and be comfortable training at high RPEs. If you're still making linear progress, run the Building Phase first.

BLOCK STRUCTURE

Weeks 1-4: Accumulation — moderate intensity, building volume
Weeks 5-8: Intensification — heavier loads, reduced accessories
Weeks 9-12: Peak Strength — near-max work on compounds
Weeks 13-16: Hypertrophy Focus — higher volume, moderate loads

Weeks 17-20: Integration — best of both, test new maxes in week 20

Deloads: Week 4, 8, 12, 16 (reduce load 40%, maintain reps)

WEEKS 1-4 — ACCUMULATION

DAY 1 — PUSH (BENCH FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Competition Bench Press	5	5	7-8	3-4 min
Close-Grip Bench Press	3	8-10	8	2.5 min
Incline Dumbbell Press	3	10-12	8	2 min
Standing OHP	3	8-10	8	2 min
Cable Lateral Raise	4	12-15	9	60 sec
Dips (Weighted)	3	8-12	8	2 min

DAY 2 — PULL (DEADLIFT FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Conventional Deadlift	5	3-5	7-8	4 min
Barbell Row (Underhand)	4	6-8	8	2.5 min
Weighted Pull-Ups	4	6-10	8	2.5 min
Chest-Supported Row	3	10-12	9	90 sec
Face Pull	3	15-20	8	60 sec
Barbell Curl	3	10-12	9	60 sec

DAY 3 — LEGS (SQUAT FOCUS)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Back Squat	5	5	7-8	3-4 min
Front Squat	3	6-8	8	2.5 min

Romanian Deadlift	3	8-10	8	2 min
Leg Press	3	10-15	9	2 min
Leg Curl	3	12-15	9	60 sec
Standing Calf Raise	4	10-15	9	60 sec

DAY 4 — UPPER (VOLUME)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Incline Barbell Bench	4	8-10	8	2.5 min
Seated Cable Row (Wide)	4	10-12	8	2 min
Dumbbell Fly	3	12-15	9	90 sec
Lat Pulldown	3	10-12	9	90 sec
Hammer Curl	3	10-12	9	60 sec
Overhead Tricep Extension	3	12-15	9	60 sec

DAY 5 — LOWER (VOLUME)

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RPE	REST
Pause Squat (3-sec pause)	4	4-6	8	3 min
Sumo / Deficit Deadlift	3	5-8	8	3 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3	10/leg	8	2 min
Hip Thrust	3	10-12	9	90 sec
Leg Extension	3	12-15	9	60 sec
Seated Calf Raise	4	15-20	9	60 sec

PROGRESSION ACROSS BLOCKS

WEEKS 5-8 — INTENSIFICATION

- Compound strength sets: reduce to 3-4 reps, increase load 5-10%
- Working sets on compounds: increase to RPE 8-9
- Accessories: drop 1 set per exercise, maintain rep ranges
- Rest periods on compounds: increase to 4-5 min
- Week 8 = DELOAD

WEEKS 9-12 — PEAK STRENGTH

- Compound top sets: singles, doubles, and triples at RPE 9-9.5
- Back-off sets: 3x5 at 80-85% of top set weight
- Accessories: minimal (2 exercises per session, 2-3 sets each)
- Rest: full recovery between heavy sets (4-6 min)
- Week 12 = DELOAD — test openers for week 20 maxes

WEEKS 13-16 — HYPERTROPHY FOCUS

- Shift compounds to 4x8-10 (moderate weight, high quality reps)
- Accessories: return to full volume (3-4 sets per exercise)
- Add intensity techniques: drop sets, rest-pause on final sets
- Focus on mind-muscle connection and controlled eccentrics (3-sec negatives)
- Week 16 = DELOAD

WEEKS 17-20 — INTEGRATION & TESTING

- Return to Week 1-4 structure but at higher loads
- Compound sets: 4x3-5 at RPE 8-9
- Accessories: moderate volume (3 sets each)

- Week 19: reduce volume to 2 working sets per exercise (taper)
- Week 20: TEST WEEK — work up to new 1RM on Squat, Bench, Deadlift, OHP

WEEK 20 — MAX TESTING PROTOCOL

Spread across 3 days. Full rest between sessions. Warm up properly — the warm-up sets below are a percentage of your estimated 1RM.

WARM-UP SET	% OF EST. 1RM	REPS	REST AFTER
Set 1 (bar only)	—	10	1 min
Set 2	50%	5	2 min
Set 3	70%	3	2 min
Set 4	85%	1	3 min
Set 5	92%	1	4 min
ATTEMPT 1	**97-100%**	**1**	5 min
ATTEMPT 2	**102-105%**	**1**	5 min
ATTEMPT 3 (optional)	**105-108%**	**1**	—

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